

Definitive guide to types of dSLR lenses

If you're intending to buy a dSLR camera, you should also ponder over the kind of lens you'll be using along with it. Deciding on the right lens shouldn't be an afterthought, as it's as important a part of the camera as the flash. Camera lenses are mostly on the higher side of the budget but for some people the cost wouldn't matter as

long as the lens is right; while for the others, the decision is mostly based on the price. In today's day and age when dSLRs are constantly evolving it's best to invest in a lens as it can be used on different camera bodies. Here's a look at some of the most commonly used lens types. For buying advice, refer to Agent001's article on dSLR lenses.

Standard

Most cameras today come with a standard kit lens that covers a focal length range of about 18-55 mm. The standard focal length magnification in lenses today is 35 mm. Standard lenses are capable of offering modest wide angle settings and a modest telephoto effect.



Superzoom

Superzoom lenses cover a wide range of shooting situations. Aimed at a professional user these lenses have a focal length range of about 18-200 mm or 18-250mm. At maximum zoom, you have to have a very steady hand else you will get shaky images.

Prime Lens

These lenses have a fixed focal length with the 'Nifty Fifty' 50 mm lens being the most popular. It is ideal for portraits and due to its wide aperture opening (f2.0, f1.8, etc.) you get a very shallow depth of field in your photographs.

Wideangle

If you want to capture a sweeping landscape that is to fit a wide range of scenery in your focal



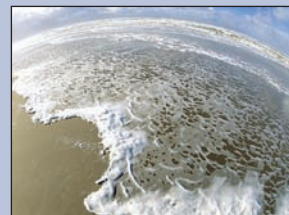
range, a wideangle lens helps. The focal length of a wideangle lens is less than 35 mm. The shorter the focal length the more the number of objects you can fit in your range. For example, a 20 mm lens is wide enough to capture an expansive landscape.

Telephoto Zoom

Meant for sports, action and wildlife photography, Telephoto zoom lenses in the range of 200-300 mm are used. Super telephoto lenses are used by professional photographers although such lenses are not widely used due to their high price.

Fisheye

Fisheye lens is a type of wideangle lens which got popular among photographers due to its hemispherical effect. A fisheye lens gives a distorted one-off result in your pictures which can't be obtained from other lenses. These were used by the meteorology department to study the formation of clouds and are also called whole sky lenses. These are quite popular among enthusiast photographers due to its ability to bend straight looking objects.



The above image shows how much area is covered by a particular lens based on its focal length